Easy RX Cycle

FREE GUIDE · FOR COMPOUNDING PHARMACIES

The Compounding Pharmacy's Guide to Compliant Waste Disposal.

Bulk APIs, failed batches, hazardous drugs and controlled substances: a compounder's waste, handled right.

DEA-REGISTERED | EPA-COMPLIANT | NO CONTRACT | CERTIFICATE OF DESTRUCTION

Easy Rx Cycle · DEA-registered medical & pharmaceutical waste destruction
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COMPLIANCE, MADE SIMPLE.

A compounder's waste is different.

A compounding pharmacy makes medications from bulk ingredients, so its waste looks different from a dispensing pharmacy's: bulk active ingredients recorded by weight, failed batches and beyond-use-date preparations, hazardous drugs handled under USP 800, controlled substances, and the sharps and PPE that come out of the compounding room. Each stream has its own rule. This guide covers every one.

The good news
We handle compounding waste (hazardous drugs, controlled substances, expired preparations and sharps) with compliant destruction. We do all the DEA paperwork, and you get a Certificate of Destruction every time. No contract.

AT A GLANCE

Who regulates what.

Agency	What it covers in your pharmacy
State board	Compounding standards (USP <795>, <797> and <800>), beyond-use dating, inspections and record keeping.
DEA	Controlled substances, including bulk controlled APIs: transfer records, Form 222 for Schedule II, and Form 41 when they're destroyed.
EPA	RCRA: hazardous pharmaceutical waste identification, segregation and destruction (Subpart P for healthcare facilities).
OSHA	Bloodborne Pathogens and Hazard Communication: sharps containers, hazardous-drug handling and staff training.
DOT	Safe packaging and shipping of regulated waste in transit.

THE STREAMS

Every stream, in depth.

Below is each regulated stream a compounding pharmacy produces: what belongs in it, what doesn't, the rule behind it, how to dispose of it, and a tip to keep it clean.

WASTE STREAM 01

Expired & failed preparations

Finished preparations past their beyond-use date, failed or out-of-spec batches, and recalled product.

GOES IN THIS STREAM	DOES NOT GO HERE
● Preparations past their beyond-use date ● Failed / out-of-spec batches ● Recalled or quarantined product	● Sharps (sharps kit) ● Controlled or hazardous preparations (own paths below)

THE RULE · Document the batch and why it failed, then destroy it with records. Never drain-dispose.

DISPOSE WITH · Pharmaceutical waste mail-back kit for non-hazardous preparations; a scheduled pickup for large batches.

> **Tip**
> Pull beyond-use-date product on a set schedule so it never sits on the shelf next to active stock.

WASTE STREAM 02

Bulk APIs & raw materials

Expired bulk powders, opened containers past their assigned dating, and stock solutions.

GOES IN THIS STREAM	DOES NOT GO HERE
● Expired bulk active ingredients ● Opened containers past dating ● Stock and base solutions	● Controlled bulk (controlled path) ● Hazardous APIs (RCRA path)

THE RULE · Record the remaining weight of every container before it leaves, so your records close out to the gram.

DISPOSE WITH · Pharmaceutical waste kit (non-hazardous), RCRA hazardous kit (hazardous APIs), controlled substance kit (controlled APIs).

> **Tip**
> Weigh it before you ship it. Bulk recorded by container instead of by weight is the most common record gap we see.

WASTE STREAM 03

Hazardous drugs (USP 800 & RCRA)

Hazardous active ingredients and preparations: chemotherapy agents, some hormones, and P- and U-listed drugs.

GOES IN THIS STREAM	DOES NOT GO HERE
● P-listed drugs (warfarin 0.3% or more, nicotine)	● Non-hazardous drugs
● U-listed drugs	● Controlled substances (own path)
● Characteristic waste (ignitable, toxic)	● Trace-contaminated PPE (trace chemo)
● Bulk chemotherapy agents	

THE RULE · EPA RCRA: identify P- and U-listed and characteristic drugs, segregate them and destroy them to EPA standards. Handle under USP 800.

DISPOSE WITH · RCRA hazardous mail-back kit.

> **Tip**
> USP 800's hazardous-drug list and EPA's RCRA lists are not the same. A drug can be on one and not the other, so check both.

WASTE STREAM 04

Controlled substances

Controlled ingredients and preparations: testosterone and other anabolic steroids, ketamine, opioids for sterile compounding, phentermine.

GOES IN THIS STREAM	DOES NOT GO HERE
● Expired controlled bulk	● Non-controlled drugs (pharmaceutical kit)
● Failed batches with controlled content	● Patients' returned medication (unless you're a registered collector)
● Beyond-use-date controlled preparations	

THE RULE · DEA: controlled stock goes to a DEA-registered reverse distributor. We prepare the transfer paperwork (Form 222 for Schedule II), destroy it and complete Form 41.

DISPOSE WITH · Controlled substance mail-back kit, or a scheduled pickup for large write-offs.

> **Tip**
> Testosterone is Schedule III. It's the controlled ingredient compounders hold most often, and the one most often missed on a disposal record.

WASTE STREAM 05

Sharps & contaminated PPE

Needles and syringes from sterile compounding, plus gloves, gowns and mats from hazardous-drug compounding.

GOES IN THIS STREAM	DOES NOT GO HERE
● Needles & syringes	● Drugs and bulk powders
● Filter needles & vial adapters	● Regular trash
● Trace-contaminated gloves & gowns (trace chemo)	

THE RULE · OSHA: FDA-cleared, puncture-resistant sharps containers. Trace-contaminated PPE goes in a yellow trace chemo container.

DISPOSE WITH · Sharps mail-back kit; trace chemo mail-back kit for contaminated PPE.

> **Tip**
> Sterile compounding uses more sharps than most pharmacies expect, so size the container to your volume.

YOUR CHECKLIST

The compounding pharmacy compliance checklist.

- ☐ Beyond-use-date and failed preparations destroyed with batch records.
- ☐ Remaining bulk weighed and matched to your log before it leaves.
- ☐ Hazardous drugs checked against both the USP 800 and RCRA lists, segregated and destroyed to EPA standards.
- ☐ Controlled substances sent to a DEA-registered reverse distributor, with the paperwork handled for you.
- ☐ Sharps in FDA-cleared containers; trace-contaminated PPE in trace chemo containers.
- ☐ Certificates of Destruction kept with your compounding records for at least two years.

QUESTIONS COMPOUNDERS ASK

Your compounding questions, answered.

How do we dispose of a failed compounded batch?

Document the batch, its ingredients and why it failed, then send it out for destruction. Controlled and hazardous batches follow their own paths, and everything is documented for your records.

How do we dispose of expired bulk controlled powders?

Weigh what's left, match it to your log, and send it to a DEA-registered reverse distributor. We prepare the paperwork, destroy it, complete Form 41 and send a Certificate of Destruction.

Are all USP 800 hazardous drugs RCRA hazardous waste?

No. The lists overlap but aren't the same. A drug on one list and not the other still needs the right handling, and we can help you sort it.

Can patients return compounded medication to us?

Only if your pharmacy is registered with the DEA as a collector for controlled drugs. Otherwise, point patients to an authorized take-back site.

Do we need a contract?

No. No contract and no minimums. Order kits as you need them or schedule a pickup.

THE EASY WAY

Handle it with mail-back.

Easy Rx Cycle ships a mail-back kit for each stream, with a prepaid return label and a Certificate of Destruction on every order. For large batches, recalls or a full cleanout, we scope a scheduled pickup. No contract.

QUICK REFERENCE · WHICH KIT FOR WHICH STREAM

Waste stream	The right path
Expired / failed preparations	Pharmaceutical waste kit, or a scheduled pickup for large batches
Non-hazardous bulk APIs	Pharmaceutical waste kit
Hazardous drugs / APIs	RCRA hazardous kit
Controlled substances	Controlled substance kit (we do the DEA paperwork)
Sharps	Sharps mail-back kit
Trace-contaminated PPE	Trace chemo kit

Prefer pickup, or higher volume?
Large failed batches, recalls and facility closures usually call for a scheduled pickup. Get a quote at easyrxcycle.com/get-a-quote or call 501-904-2929.

WHY COMPOUNDING PHARMACIES CHOOSE EASY RX CYCLE

- No contract, no minimums: order as you need it
- A DEA-registered reverse distributor: we do all the DEA paperwork
- One vendor for every stream you generate
- Licensed nationally, serving all 50 states
- A Certificate of Destruction on every order

Ready to simplify your compounding waste?

Shop mail-back kits with prices, or get a custom quote for pickup and higher volume. No contract.

501-904-2929 · sales@easyrxcycle.com · easyrxcycle.com/shop